

Bulk Import Members

How to add multiple members at once using the Bulk Import feature.

Location

Members page → top-right button group → **Bulk Import** (the blue/info button next to **Add New**).

Template: `app/templates/users.html` Route: `app/users_routes.py:573` (`bulk_import_users`, POST `/user/bulk_import`)

Permission

Requires the `MEMBERS_MANAGE` permission (typically held by Admins / SAA).

Steps

1. Navigate to the **Members** page.
2. Click **Bulk Import** — this opens the hidden file picker (`#bulk-import-form`).
3. Select a `.csv` file.
4. The browser submits the file as a `multipart/form-data` POST to `/user/bulk_import`.
5. Review the flash messages after the redirect — the page reports how many users were imported plus any row-level errors.

CSV Format

The file must have a header row (which is skipped) and up to 5 columns:

#	Column	Required	Notes
1	Fullname	Yes	Used to look up a matching Contact (linked if found)
2	Username	Yes	Must be unique across users
3	Member ID	No	Stored only
4	Email	No	Must be unique if provided; checked against existing users
5	Mentor Name	No	Used to look up a Contact and set as mentor (linked if found)

Example

```
Fullname,Username,Member ID,Email,Mentor Name
Jane Doe,janed,12345,jane@example.com,John Smith
Bob Lee,blee,12346,bob@example.com,
```

Behavior

- **Default password:** `toastmasters` (users should change on first login).
- **Default role:** `Member` (resolved from `AuthRole` by name).

- **Duplicate username:** row is skipped, reported in flash error.
- **Duplicate email:** row is skipped, reported in flash error.
- **Contact linking:** if a `Contact.Name` matches `Fullname`, the new user is linked to that contact (`contact_id`).
- **Mentor linking:** if a `Contact.Name` matches `Mentor Name`, the mentor is resolved to a `mentor_id`.
- **Rows with fewer than 2 non-empty cells** are skipped silently.
- **Final summary flash:** `N users imported successfully.` plus per-row error messages.

Errors You May See

- No file part — request had no file field.
- No selected file — file input was empty.
- Invalid file type. Please upload a .csv file. — file did not end in .csv.
- You don't have permission to perform this action. — caller lacks `MEMBERS_MANAGE`.
- Skipping row: `Fullname` and `Username` are mandatory. Row: ...
- Skipping user '<username>': User already exists.
- Skipping user '<username>': Email '<email>' is already registered.

Related

- There is no companion “Export members” button in the UI. Use the Members page table’s existing export (if available) or query the database directly.
- The CLI command `flask import-data` (in `app/commands/import_data.py`) is a **separate, much broader** importer — it loads a full SQL backup for a club, not a member CSV. Do not use it for routine member onboarding.